

Game Behavior Expectation:

The game operates entirely under .NET package and Splashkit library, using C# and possibly Console App as the base. No other libraries, engines, package should be expected.

1. Screens:

- Start Screen:

- + New Game (button): Start a new game from the beginning of the story
- + Continue (button): Open a Save and Load Menu
- + Options (button): Open to an Option Screen, where several options to modify settings like sound. However, this is optional currently (could place a implemented later warning if needed)
- + Exit (button): Exit the Program
- + Background (Image): A possibly static or infinitely (something related to 7 could be good) vertically (preferably?) or horizontally looping image

Example:



- Save and Load Menu screen:



Instead of Chapter, it would be Loop. (Ex.: Loop: 4).

Playtime and date/month/year would be recorded through system, based exactly on their timezone.

No Gems, (optional) could be Corruption Meter if it's revealed during the specific loop in-game. I should have already specified how this work before, but the details may appear below.

(Optional) There is only one character sprite and slot, with the name but no level. Everything else is the same.

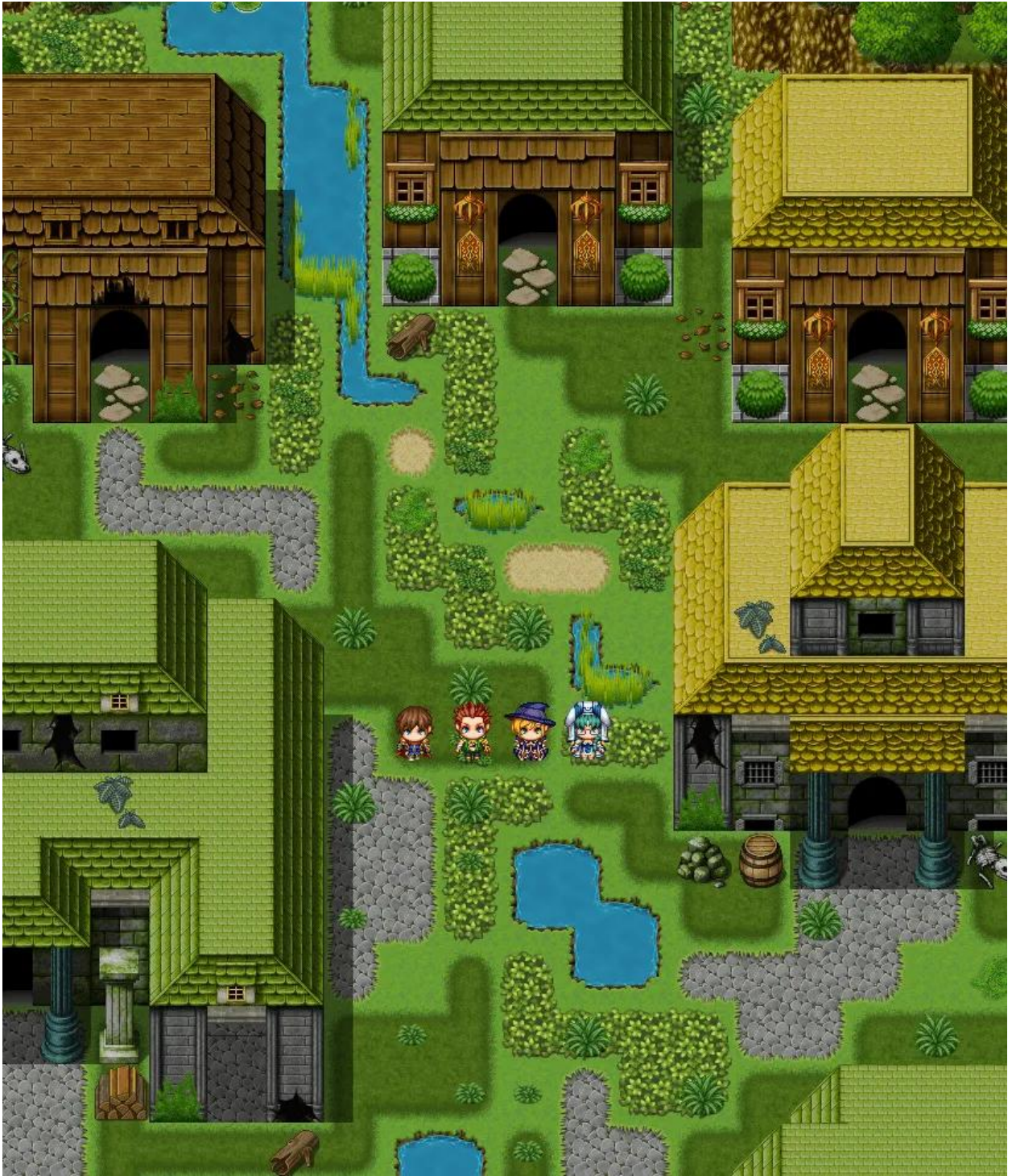
Limited to 7 save slots (that can hold 7 load files, reiterating to make sure).

- Main Gameplay Screen:

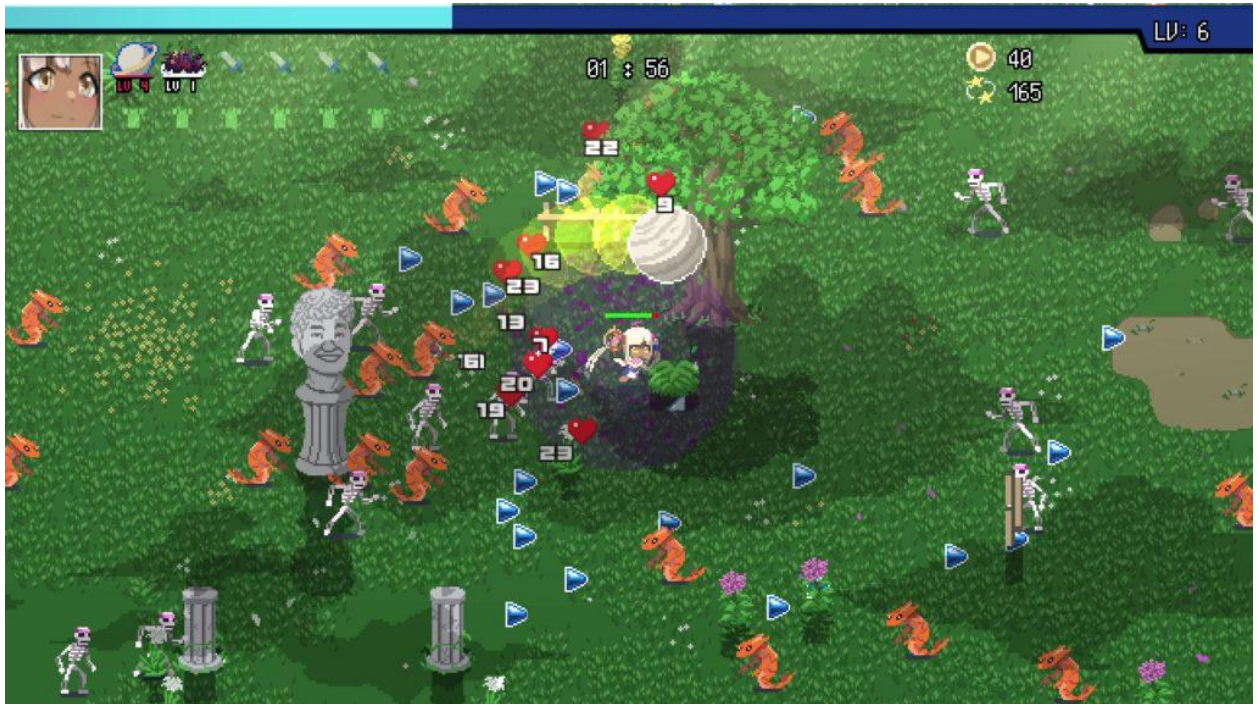
- + Exploration State:

- Example:

- Village:



+ Battle State:



This example is from Holocure. The only difference would be that:

- + There are not this many beasts
- + Beasts have 3 states: Normal, Partial Corruption and Corruption but they don't have a lot of varieties in look. They also don't drop those small stuff on death and there is no exp bar at the top. (I will deal with the sprites later, make sure the logic is correct)
- + There is a mandatory hp bar at the top left with numerical values
- + No lines of weapons and accessories (the ones on top left for holocure)
- + No gold coins, total kill or time recorded
- + No face avatar on top left
- + The map is expandable by moving, and the camera focus is on the character (true for all states, this state is especially important)
- + Dialogue State:



It's simply like this. There are several options and notes:

- + The dialogue and answer should honestly not overlap any character sprite that is the player (may overlap npc sprite since their position is fixed, unless it's the npc the player is interacting with)
- + The answer/player dialogue choice doesn't have to be a small branch-off from the main dialogue box, it could also be presented directly within the box with yellow (flexible) box highlights.
- + There is only one main playable sprite

+ Loop Reset State:

It's basically like New Game, but with some saved data. This saved data is the Favor Meter and the Knowledge Clues.

Everything else like inventory (containing items), activated questline, activated rewards (eg. access to special subareas) are wiped. This does not include the Cult altar area, as it's activated by knowledge clue

You may define this state better or remove it or rename it to reflect its function better.

2. Essential Components:

- + Movement: Must be able to move in 4 directions. That 4 directions movement must support even diagonal movement (not as in a separate sprite movement, but rather just moving in such direction possible)

+ Sprites: Prioritize Player (1) and beasts being able to have action animation. Beasts could be minimal, since I don't expect complex combat strategies. Most NPC sprites are expected to be static. May consider some moving on a preset route at a certain timezone, but that's the extent of it.

+ Collision: Player (sprite) and beasts should have a hitbox. Player can have an extension box use when attacking (left mouse) that can interact with beast's hitbox. Static assets, such as trees, houses, and map borders, should prevent players from passing through or exiting the screen boundaries. NPC sprites can be considered static assets. RPGmaker is a good reference.

+ Interactable Objects: Excluding certain background static assets, like trees and the ground, most objects are interactable to some degree. Static assets like houses, caves, cliffs, etc can trigger an inspection effect (press a button to inspect with notifications of that and if pressed, show a dialogue line of predefined player's thought). Inspecting NPC can show a brief description of them, including name, may include knowledge clues gathered from them, about them. Brief descriptions may change for special objects. Esc can help exit this.

+ NPCs: NPCs are special interactable objects that can be talked to, with several dialogue choices when the player decides to talk to them. Opening lines may differ depending on the period/day, but most dialogue choices remain the same. During a specific period in time (for example 3rd day, 1st loop, evening), an unique option may appear if you decided to talk to them after finding them. This will be elaborated on more in dialogue.

There are 8 interactable NPCs:

- The neighbour granny
- The old guard
- The alcoholic uncle
- The retired priest
- The Recluse youth
- The bartender
- The widow
- The Lumber

+ Special NPCs: These are NPCs with unique interactions, namely The Seer and Daughter. They have special functions that NPCs can't do.

The seer, or rather seer's subarea, may only be unlocked after having the right knowledge clue, and has a gameplay limit per loop. Every time Player uses her service, there is a counter to count up to a total of 5. Just going to her place doesn't trigger anything. The

service requires you to do a request for her, costing 1 AP. 3 services include: Insight (Temporary reveal of Corruption Meter for the day, limit 2 per loop), Revelation (1 random clue to event that gets knowledge clue, limit 2 per loop), Cleanse (10% Reduction of Player Corruption Meter, limit 3 per loop).

The Daughter will have an animation trigger or static scene transition where she tucks the father in at the last day of the loop. This will happen whether the father spends the night outside or not. The direction is after the last AP is spent, the screen blacks out, either transitioning to a static scene with drawing and dialogue or just dialogue in a black screen.

The Daughter is the final boss (this will not be revealed to the player from the beginning). When enough knowledge clues are gathered, an option when interacting with the daughter will appear, named "Truth".

+ Beasts: Beast are Player's Enemies that can attack when player's in the forest area. Their attack patterns are basically like the attack patterns of enemies in Holocure. (Suggestion: When player is within aggro range, beast will start approaching the player and when within attack range, will trigger an attack animation after a small interval.)

There are two types of beast: Mobs and Elite. Elite have 2x health and 1.5x damage compared to its mob counterpart. Beasts can kill player if it depletes player health bar.

+ Area: There are two types, a main area and a subarea. A subarea belongs to a main area, or can be to another subarea. There are three main areas: Village, Munia Forest, and The Temple (Destroyed). Village have 1 subareas: Home (when entering home, Daughter will always be present). Munia Forest have 2 subareas: The Cliff (leads to Seer's Hut subarea) and The Cave (leads to Cult Altar subarea), both locked and needs certain knowledge clue.

Cult Altar: Contains an item that permanently show Corruption Meter for the entire loop.

Seer's Hut: Seer is located there. Subarea locked after 4 service for the loop.

Temple: Can be visited and inspected. Inspected dialogue will change if player obtained a specific knowledge clue, allowing player to talk to a special NPC-like being called God of Give and Take. Other than preset dialogue and options, there is a dialogue option where Player can receive 3 help that span all loop (meaning once 3 help is up, it can't be refreshed by loop. For example, 1 help was used in loop 2, there will only be 2 help left in loop 2 to 7. If all help expired in loop 5, no remaining help will be available for loop 6 and 7). The help are: Escape (leads to an instant game ending, not bad end), Regain Humanity (cleanse 100% corruption meter), Reveal True Favor Balance (includes hidden favor, last 2 loop).

+ Dialogues: A crucial mechanism in the game. Appears when Player talks to NPCs, interacting with objects by inspecting, by an event,...Dialogues are preset for most objects, however there are conditional ones that only appear when certain conditions are met.

As mentioned above, these conditions can trigger at a specific period (for example 3rd day, 1st loop, evening), where an unique dialogue option may appear. This will require Time Tracker (below).

There are also unique favor dialogue options. “Spill a Secret” and “Kill Thyself” are default locked options for everybody except Daughter and Seer. The reason why they’re locked will be explained below.

Dialogue’s main component include a main dialogue box that displays character lines (dialogues). This is elaborated in the above section.

+ Favor: A intergal part of the plot progression and dialogue system. Each NPC will have an unique Favor relationship with player (Favor – Favor). Players can gain favor by doing daily requests (subjugation, watch the house, etc...). Only Subjugation request will have you move to another location to kill monster and fulfill the number required. Other just black out and take the AP accordingly. NPCs may gain favor by Player asking them to look after the daughter (1 default request), which when enough, allows them to refuse an unique favor dialogue option if the number match, or the number from the NPC prevails. Example, ask NPC to spill a secret when Player - NPC (spends 15 – have 16) -> Player lost 15 favors, NPC favor reduced to 1. This doesn’t demonstrate that player can only have 15 favor on the npc, but rather that as long as the npc have more favor points than the favor dialogue option cost, they can refuse it with a preset refusal.

There are two separate parameters for favor. It’s assumed that player’s favor with every npc starts at 0 (0 – 0) meaning no one can use favor against each other. This is the present favor. However, there is (lore-related reason) a hidden favor parameter that player may only know off when enough knowledge clues is present. Since favor is unique from NPC to NPC, the amount is a little different but not substantial, and requires different knowledge clues for each NPCs.

+ Corruption:

NPCs (except Seer and Daughter), Player and Beast are subjected to Corruption.

Beasts have three states: Normal (0%), Partial (1-99%) and Complete Corruption (100%). The % don’t matter in actual battle mechanic, just to distinguish what constitutes which states. Partial and Complete Corruption have a chance of increasing corruption meter in player when player is damaged (A chance, not guaranteed). Partial is 10% chance to give

3% corruption, Complete is 40% chance to give 5% corruption. Most beasts will be normal in loop 1, and as more loop went by (maximum loop 7), more beasts will be spawned partial and complete corruption.

NPC Corruption Meter increase randomly per loop (lower end: 11%, upper end: 17%). At 50% corruption and above, certain effects will happen.

50 – 60% (Dialogue text corrupts, certain letters disappear or just outright a sentence inbetween)

60 - 80%: Alongside the above effect, there's a chance their house will be their placeholder instead of their sprite – meaning they locked themselves inside like being sick. They can trigger (gacha) either the normal talk or refusal to talk).

Special Note: The Recluse will be like this from the beginning (0% Corruption). You can inspect the house 3 times and the Recluse start talking.

80 - 100%: No respond, only a preset dialogue of suffering can be heard in house

Player:

Gain 10% Corruption when new loop starts.

Gain 10% Corruption when not staying home at night (Spend 1 AP outside of Home at Night period)

Loser 25% of total Corruption if stay at home at night (Spend 1 AP at Home at Night period)

Corruption Meter retains through loop (retains %).

Gain 10% Corruption per death and instantly jumps to next day per death (beast kill).

At 77%, daughter can give subtle special warning dialogue three time when talk to (warning happen 1/day). After 3 warning, if retain or > (higher) percentage, instant bad ending "Preservation".

Loop: There are 7 loops total. Player start at loop 1. If by loop 7 daughter wasn't exposed, receive ending "Lullaby".

Endings: Ending instantly end the game, no new loops.

Knowledge Clues: Obtainable per conditional dialogue, quests. Persists through loops.

AP: Action points, can forward periods of a day. 2 for Morning, 1 for Afternoon, 1 for Evening, 1 for Night. Most action like daily request spends 1 AP, talking (click unchosen dialogue options) spends 1 AP,....

Quest: Like Conditional Dialogue, only appear at certain periods and for specific NPCs. Spend 1 additional AP if taken.

Inventory: Player has an inventory with 5 item slots. This is technically like a bag too, so there is no separate bag.

Stats: Player have fixed stats: HP (Health), ATK, Defense, Agility, Dexterity (Crit chance, crit damage is x2 ATK). These stats will decrease by 20% at 50% Corruption, 10% further decrease per extra 10% Corruption. These will affect movement and combat mechanics (move slower per lower agility, deal less damage per hit, take more damage per hit,...)

+ Tracker: There are several tracker this game should contain:

- Time Tracker: Track the period of day (Morning/Afternoon/Evening/Night, integral to event and unique dialogues), the loop number (integral to plot progression system), and the day number (eg. Day 2). That's it for now.
- Favor Tracker: This will track all favor relationships and allow the activation of favor dialogue options, as well as the balance at all times to make sure the system works right.
- Corruption Meter: This meter is hidden by default to player, keeps track of Player's corruption from the beginning to ending (starts at 0%). An item from Cult Altar can reveal this meter permanently for the loop, and Seer can reveal it for a day.
- HP meter: A bar of health that regenerates after a day ends (after night passes). Doesn't regenerate during the day.
- Subjugation Tracker: Subjugation daily request can track how many beasts were killed. The total amount kill per type can be tracked as well, and when 100 is killed, mobs of the type can be insta-killed.
- Quest Tracker: Track which quest have been finished and disable it for the player. Makes sure that if player have earned a knowledge clue after finishing such quest (maybe in previous loop), that knowledge clue remains.
- Knowledge Clues Tracker: Track All Knowledge Clue and which the player have obtained, divide into two categories named "Obtained" and "Unobtained". Integral to access of certain special conditional things like Cult Altar, God of Give and Take,...
- Dialogue Tracker: Track which option has been triggered and which is not. Track conditions that allow which options to be available or not through other tracker like

Time tracker. Options can be just normal dialogues (Must), Daily Request (Must), Quest (Conditional), Favor (Conditional)

Example for HP, Corruption Bar:

